

5 Seth

The son given "instead of Abel," through whom the line of promise continued.

Seth was the third son of Adam and Eve named in Scripture. He was born after Cain killed Abel, when the family's future seemed broken. Eve saw him as a gift from God, "another seed instead of Abel." Genesis says little about what Seth did. But his line matters: in the days of his son Enos, "then began men to call upon the name of the LORD." Through Seth the genealogy runs to Noah, then to Abraham, David and, in Luke's Gospel, to Jesus. Seth's story is a quiet reminder that God keeps his promises through ordinary faithful families.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Shet</i> . It sounds like Eve's word "appointed" in Genesis 4:25
Family	Son of Adam and Eve; father of Enos, plus other sons and daughters (Genesis 4:25–26; 5:6–7)
When	Born when Adam was 130 (Genesis 5:3)
Lifespan	912 years (Genesis 5:8)
Key people	Adam, Eve, Enos
Main passages	Genesis 4:25–26; 5:3–8
New Testament	Luke 3:38

"And to Seth, to him also there was born a son; and he called his name Enos: then began men to call upon the name of the LORD."

Genesis 4:26, KJV

The life of Seth

Ages come from Genesis 5 in the Hebrew text. The Greek Septuagint gives different numbers.

- Adam's 130th year
 - Born
 - Adam fathers a son "in his own likeness, after his image" and names him Seth. Eve says God has appointed him "instead of Abel, whom Cain slew." *Genesis 4:25; 5:3*
- Age 105
 - Father of Enos
 - Seth fathers Enos. In his days people begin to call on the name of the LORD. *Genesis 4:26; 5:6*
- The next 807 years
 - Raises a family
 - Seth lives on and fathers sons and daughters. *Genesis 5:7*
- Age 912
 - Dies
 - "All the days of Seth were nine hundred and twelve years: and he died." *Genesis 5:8*

Group notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

Key activities

Genesis 6:2 speaks of "the sons of God" marrying "the daughters of men." One view says these were Seth's godly descendants marrying Cain's line. Others see them as angels or as powerful rulers. Genesis does not say.

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- 1 Was received as God's gift.** Eve named him as the seed God appointed after Abel's death. *Genesis 4:25*
 - 2 Bore Adam's likeness.** He was born in Adam's likeness and image, echoing how Adam was made in God's likeness. *Genesis 5:1-3*
 - 3 Fathered Enos.** He named his son Enos, whose name means "man." *Genesis 4:26*
 - 4 Saw worship begin.** In his son's days, people began to call on the name of the LORD. *Genesis 4:26*
 - 5 Carried the line to Noah.** Genesis 5 traces the family from Seth through Enoch and Methuselah to Noah. *Genesis 5:6-32*
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Group notes

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Seth.

Old Testament

Genesis 4:25–26	and 5:3–8. These are the main passages about Seth.
Genesis 5:9–32	His descendants run from Enos to Noah.
1 Chronicles 1:1	The genealogy begins "Adam, Sheth, Enosh."
Echoes	Calling on the name of the LORD becomes a mark of true worship. Abraham builds altars and calls on the name of the LORD (Genesis 12:8).

New Testament

Luke 3:38	Luke traces Jesus back "which was the son of Enos, which was the son of Seth, which was the son of Adam."
Echoes	"Whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved" (Romans 10:13, quoting Joel 2:32).

For discussion

1. *Observe:* What did Eve say when Seth was born (Genesis 4:25)?
2. *Understand:* Why might it matter that people began to call on the LORD in the days of Seth's son?
3. *Apply:* Seth's family carried faith forward quietly. Who passed faith on to you?
4. *Apply:* What is one way you can help the next generation "call upon the name of the LORD"?